

Cricut Joy Set

WHAT'S IN THE KIT

- Cricut Joy with blade and pen
- Vinyl and heat-transfer sheets in a variety of colors
- Weeding and placement tools



QUICK-START GUIDE

1. Design in Cricut Design Space (free) on a computer or tablet.
2. Load vinyl, send the cut, then 'weed' away the excess.
3. Use transfer tape to place vinyl decals; use heat-transfer vinyl with the Heat Press for fabric.
4. The pen attachment also draws cards and labels.

FULL LESSONS IN THIS GUIDE

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PRO TIP: 'Weeding' the vinyl is oddly the most beloved step. Budget time for it.

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LESSON · GRADES 3-5

Label the World

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will design labels with typography and layout intent
- Students will operate a design-to-cut workflow
- Students will improve a shared space through design

MATERIALS

- Cricut Joy + vinyl + transfer tape
- Computer/tablet with Cricut Design Space (free)
- Label audit sheet: what in our room needs labeling?
- Weeding tools (supervised)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Label audit walk: teams list unlabeled bins, shelves, and stations.
2. Typography mini-lesson: readable beats fancy at label size.
3. Design labels in Design Space: consistent size and font family per zone.
4. Cut, then teach weeding — peeling the excess is everyone's favorite job.
5. Transfer-tape application: level, centered, bubble-free.
6. Room reveal walk: the class tours its newly labeled ecosystem.

ACTIVITY

Label the World — a real signage system for their own classroom, designed with typographic intent. The immediate daily usefulness makes design feel like a public service.

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LESSON · GRADES 6-8

Sticker Brand Studio

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will develop a personal visual brand
- Students will prepare vector-friendly designs for cutting
- Students will iterate designs against manufacturing constraints

MATERIALS

- Cricut Joy + assorted vinyl
- Design Space accounts
- Brand sheet: name/logo concept, two colors, style words
- Weeding stations with tools

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Brand workshop: each student defines a personal mark — initials, symbol, or wordmark.
2. Teach the manufacturing reality: thin lines and tiny details weed terribly.
3. Design v1 and cut a test — the weeding experience IS the design feedback.
4. Revise for cuttability: thicken, simplify, close gaps.
5. Cut final decals; apply to notebooks or water bottles.
6. Reflection: what did the machine teach you that the screen didn't?

ACTIVITY

Sticker Brand Studio — personal logos that must survive the blade and the weeding hook. 'The machine rejected my design' is the gentlest possible intro to manufacturing constraints.

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LESSON · GRADES 9-12

Client Signage Commission

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will manage client work through approval workflows
- Students will produce signage to specification
- Students will install and quality-check a finished product

MATERIALS

- Cricut Joy + vinyl inventory
- Design Space + client request form
- Real signage requests from around the school
- Approval sign-off sheet and installation kit (level, tape, squeegee)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Collect real requests: door signs, lab labels, office nameplates, event signage.
2. Client intake: exact wording, size, colors, placement — in writing.
3. Design proofs sent for client approval BEFORE cutting; revisions logged.
4. Production: cut, weed, and prep with transfer tape.
5. Professional installation: level, aligned, bubble-free, client present.
6. Client satisfaction sign-off closes each job; portfolio photographs archived.

ACTIVITY

Client Signage Commission — a working sign shop with intake forms, proof approvals, and installation sign-offs. The revision-request from a real client is the workplace-readiness lesson.